

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS



INDIA - AFRICA - 1

MODULE - 44

INDIA AND AFRICA

- 1 India-Africa relations are dominated by historicity of their interactions.
- 2 It is a century-old partnership with socio-cultural linkages, thriving diasporas and nationalist movements.
- 3 India and Africa share a long and rich history of interaction that date back to ancient civilisations including the trade ties between the Nile and Indus valleys.
- 4 These relations can be defined as continuity and change

- 5 Africa has a huge market with over a billion population and GDP of over 2.5 trillion dollars



INDIA AND AFRICA

6 In 2019, PM Modi spoke at the Ugandan Parliament and said that “India’s priority is Africa and its people. Our shared values and our friendship represent a constant as well as ignite a continuity”.

7 In the 21st century, India is making an effort to redefine its position and role both in the regional and global context. This is, shaped by its growing economic status and also its role as the leader of the South



- 1 India shared a colonial heritage with many African countries.
- 2 It has significantly contributed to this connection as the migration of many Indian workers to Southern and Eastern Africa has established large diasporas in these areas.
- 3 The foundations of the relationship were laid by Mahatma Gandhi.



4 Mahatma Gandhi, observed in the early 20th century, “The commerce between India and Africa will be of ideas and services, not of manufactured goods against raw materials after the fashion of Western exploiters.”

5 India's attitude towards Africa in the post-World War II era has been directed by principles of South-South cooperation, such as respect for state sovereignty, non-interference, mutual benefit and equality.

6 The countries have fought against colonialism, racial prejudice and rights of every man and woman



- 1 Originally adopted in 1955 at the Bandung Conference, the Non-alignment approach was reaffirmed in the New Asian-African Strategic Partnership of 2005.
- 2 India's broader approach of economic, technical, and cultural cooperation for mutual benefit promotes the values of egalitarian solidarity.
- 3 India provided leadership to the Non-Aligned Movement and African countries acted as a strengthening factor
- 4 In the 1960s Prime Minister Nehru spoke of Afro-Asian solidarity.

- 5 India supported Africa on the issue of Apartheid



AREAS OF COOPERATION

POLITICAL

- 1 Indo-African relations have matured from idealism to a more pragmatic and mutually beneficial partnership.
- 2 India's engagement with African countries is on three levels - bilateral, regional and multilateral.
- 3 In 2008, the first India-Africa Forum Summit was held in New Delhi.
- 4 Since 2010, it has opened a dialogue with the eight African Regional Economic Communities (RECs) recognised by the African Union.



POLITICAL

- 5 In 2011, at the 2nd India-Africa Forum, PM Singh referred to Africa as the 'new growth pole'. The relationship is pragmatic and mutually beneficial.
- 6 At the Third India-Africa Summit in 2015, the Asia-Africa Corridor was launched.
- 7 PM Modi referred to India and Africa as 'two bright spots of hope and opportunities in the global economy'.
- 8 To enhance diplomatic engagement, India is opening 18 new embassies in Africa, to take the total number of Indian missions to 47 out of a total of 54 countries in Africa.



DEFENCE

- 1 South Africa and India expanded defence cooperation in 1996 with the joint manufacturing of defence equipment for domestic needs and cater to regional and global demand.
- 2 India and Kenya have signed an MOU on defence cooperation as both suffer from Terrorism and Radicalisation.
- 3 India is building a naval and air base on Assumption Island, north of Madagascar and within easy reach of many of east Africa's newly discovered offshore gas fields.



DEFENCE

4 In Seychelles, Prime Minister launched a coastal surveillance radar project, announced the transfer of a Dornier aircraft and signed an agreement to build infrastructure on Assumption Island.

5 With US and Japan, India is trying to enhance cooperation with African countries.

6 Indian military academies offer training to military officers from a number of African states.

7 India has helped set up defence academies in countries such as Nigeria, Ethiopia and Tanzania.



MARITIME SECURITY

- 1 It is well known that oceans and seas are a vast reservoir of resources. India and Africa are part of the Indo- Pacific continuum
- 2
- 3 As a country with vast coast line and Exclusive Economic Zone (EEZ) and increasing dependence on maritime trade, maritime security is of vital importance for India.
- 4 On the East African coast, India faces a specific advantage as a potential security provider as the navies and coast guards of Africa are not equipped to deal with this threat.



MARITIME SECURITY

- 5 It increases the possibility of India – Africa maritime cooperation. India can support Africa through Samudri Mitrata (Friendship across the Ocean)
- 6 India can increase its delivery capacity and assume a strategic position, in the following ways-
 - By keeping these crucial sea lanes of communication and strategic chokepoints (including the Gulf of Aden and the Mozambique channel) secure,
 - developing the naval capabilities of the East African states through increased joint exercises
 - creation of new listening posts
 - supply of vessels
 - India's initiative to host the annual Indian Ocean Naval Symposium in Delhi, and its commitment to revive the Indian Ocean Rim Association for Regional Cooperation can be important steps in addressing security interests with Africa



BLUE ECONOMY

- 1 Africa has jurisdiction over 13 million square kms of maritime zone.
- 2 90% of the continent's trade is conducted through oceans. India also recognises the importance of the maritime sphere as 97% of India's trade is via sea.
- 3 The idea of the 'Blue Economy' is very important for both India and Africa.
- 4 It refers to any economic activity which directly or indirectly uses sea as an input.



BLUE ECONOMY

- 5 Blue economy includes several sectors viz. fishing, shipping and port infrastructure, marine biotech, marine manufacturing, marine renewable energy, marine tourism, marine construction, ocean government and marine education.
- 6 African Union's Agenda 2063 lays special emphasis on the development of Blue economy for the continent's growth.



INDO-AFRICAN EFFORTS IN THE BLUE ECONOMY

1 In 2014, South Africa launched Operation Phakisa to harness Blue Economy.

2 In 2015, Prime Minister Modi said that the Blue Chakra or wheel in the Indian flag represented the potential of the Blue Revolution or the Ocean Economy.

3 In 2015, Prime Minister Modi visited Mauritius and Modi unveiled a new vision in the maritime sphere by the terminology 'Security and Growth for All'(SAGAR).

4 This proactive strategy calls for increase in maritime cooperation in the Indian Ocean Region and reiterates the capacity of Oceans in India's economic and security policy.



INDO-AFRICAN EFFORTS IN THE BLUE ECONOMY

5 It is digital connectivity in the Pan-African e-network project on tele-education and telemedicine.

6

7 As a part of reinvigorating cultural links with East Africa under the rubric of 'Project Mausam' the Indian Ministry of Culture sees to revive lost linkages with the Indian Ocean.

8 The African countries have developed the Africa Integrated Maritime Strategy 2050 that provides a roadmap to deal with the maritime security challenges and measures to develop the blue economy.



ECONOMIC IMPORTANCE

- 1 Following India's economic liberalisation from 1991 onwards, Africa has emerged and is likely to remain both a crucial source for natural resources and for developing new markets.
- 2 India has emerged as a source of investment, technology and capital goods.
- 3 Given its growing market size and rising rate of private consumption, African markets hold significant importance for Indian economy.



ECONOMIC IMPORTANCE

- 4 The African continent serves as a good market for Indian consumer goods, telecommunications, agriculture, cement and textiles.
- 5 In March 2002, India shared its vision of economic diplomacy towards Africa with the Focus Africa Program covering 24 African countries.
- 6 The future areas of cooperation include infrastructure, mining, information technology, pharmaceuticals and health care, power generation and agriculture.



ECONOMIC

- The Indian and African economies represent two of the world's most dynamic economic growth stories.
- By 2030, Africa is expected to represent almost a quarter of the world's workforce and consumers.
- With 54 countries, a billion people, a youthful demographic and an abundance of resources, Africa has huge economic potential

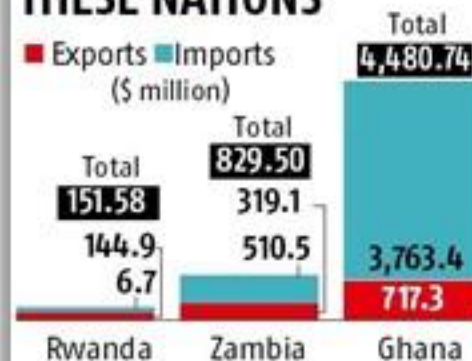


BILATERAL TRADE

ECONOMIC

- 1 Africa has emerged as an important trade and investment partner of India.
- 2 India's trade with Africa has grown from US \$5.3 billion in 2001 to \$62 billion in 2018.
- 3 India is ranked as the third largest export destination in Africa.
- 4 India has accorded Duty Free Tariff Preference (DFTP) Scheme to 38 African countries. The signing of the African Continental Free Trade Area Agreement will further boost trade and economic ties with Africa.

BILATERAL TRADE WITH THESE NATIONS



AFRICAN TRADE REMAINS FOCUSED ON FEW NATIONS



Source : Commerce Department

INDIAN ASSISTANCE TO AFRICA CONTINUES GOING UP

Source : Export-Import Bank of India

	in \$ million	
Rwanda	547.65	
Ghana	388.26	
Zambia	147.03	

For all African nations (40% of all approved LoCs)
\$11.5 billion

INVESTMENT

ECONOMIC

- 1 India has become the fifth largest investor in Africa with cumulative investments of \$ 54 billion. It has created employment opportunities for the people of Africa
- 2 India's economic presence in Africa is marked by the predominance of its private sector, including a significant number of small and medium enterprises.
- 3 Beyond resources and infrastructure, India has carved out niches such as information and telecommunication technologies, education and health services.



ECONOMIC

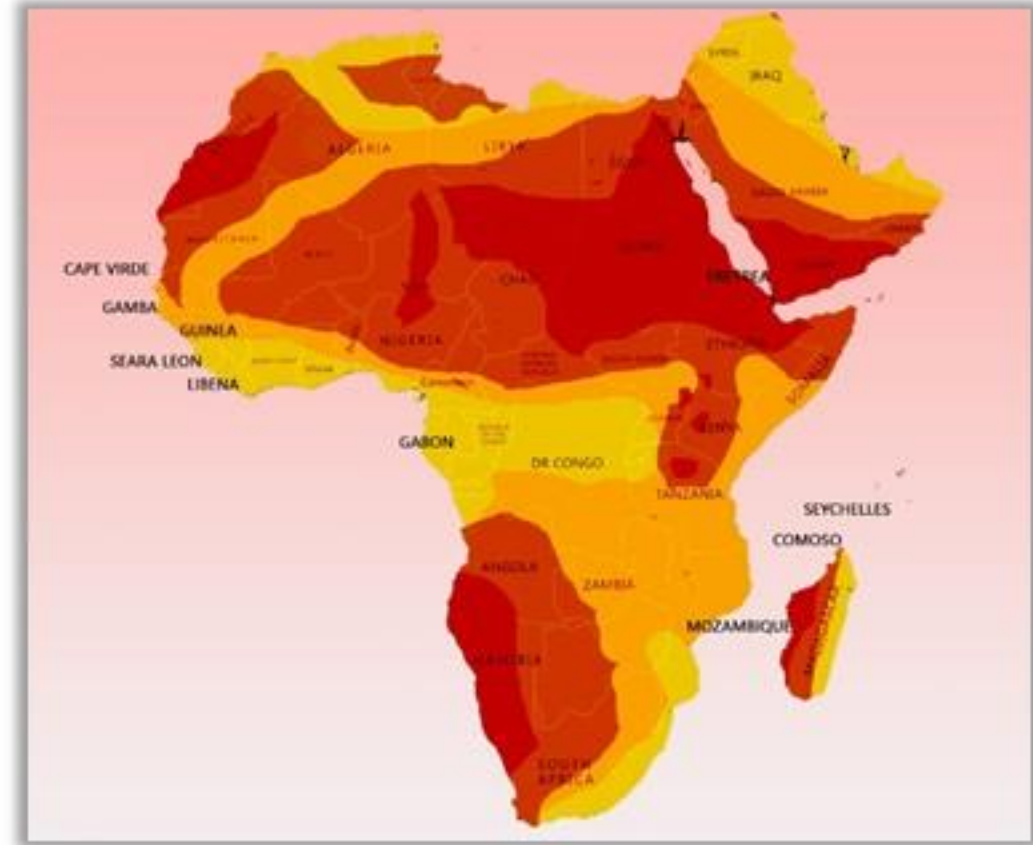
INVESTMENT

- 4** To enhance cooperation with the West African region, the India government launched the **Techno-Economic Approach for India Africa Movement (TEAM)** in partnership with eight countries in the region - Burkina Faso, Chad, Cote'd Ivoire, Equatorial Guinea, Ghana, Guinea Bissau, Mali and Senegal.
- 5** The TEAM 9 initiative envisages **transfer of critical technologies from India to the region.**
- 6** India has cooperated with Africa in the following projects-
- 7** Power projects and dams in Sudan and Rwanda; water treatment in Tanzania; sugar factories in Ethiopia; and technology parks in Mozambique and Swaziland, presidential palace in Ghana, the National Assembly building in the Gambia, the Mahatma Gandhi International Convention Centre in Niger, completed in just 14 months.



ENERGY SECURITY

- 1 Demand for food, water and energy is increasing in India and African countries.
- 2 Despite significant fossil fuel resources, access to energy is lower in Sub Saharan Africa.
- 3 India has also recently been following the footsteps of China's 'oil for infrastructure' deals in Africa as a means of acquiring resources.
- 4 Essar Oil Limited, ONGC Videsh Limited, Indian Oil Corporation and Mittal Energy Limited all have made resource seeking deals with African countries in exchange for local infrastructure development.



ENERGY SECURITY

- 5 With abundant solar, wind and water resources, Africa has a promising potential in the field of renewable energy.
- 6 As an energy deficit country, India too is interested in furthering the development of renewable energy resources.
- 7 India is keen at diversifying its oil supplies from the Middle East and Africa has a huge potential for India
- 8 Africa also contains rich reservoir of valuable minerals, metals including gold and diamond



ENERGY SECURITY

- 9 The Economic Community of West African States (ECOWAS) have developed a renewable energy policy.
- 10 For India, Solar power production is central to its renewable energy framework.
- 11 Mozambique, Tanzania, South Africa and Kenya have expressed support for India's initiative for an International Solar Alliance.



FOOD SECURITY

- 1 Food Security is an important concern for India and Africa as both India and the African countries have been ranked low in the Hunger Index.
- 2 India and African countries have similar conditions for agricultural development that provide impetus for collaboration.
- 3 Africa has 60% of the arable land in the world but produces 10% of the global food output.
- 4 Africa has ample agricultural land to address food security.
- 5 Prime Minister Modi signed an MOU to import pulses from Africa
- 6 Indian firms are also beginning to see in Africa a possible solution to their country's food security challenge



CYBER SECURITY

- 1 New technologies are rising in Africa with exponential growth in mobile smart device ownership.
- 2 With growing prosperity and digitization in Africa, there is a rise in risks and vulnerabilities that could undermine progress
- 3 Similarly, India is concerned about rising cyber threats.



CYBER SECURITY

- 4 In the area of cyber security, India can partner with African countries to deal with cyber threats and forge cyber security cooperation.
- 5 There is a need to further improve cyber security readiness and raise awareness around the importance of keeping Information Technology (IT) systems secure, and develop new security practices and procedures.
- 6 India and Africa cooperate on achieving cyber security, combating narcotics and human trafficking.



HEALTH CARE

- 1 In March 2019, India and African Union signed an agreement to initiate and strengthen cooperation in the health sector.
- 2 The MoU will pave the way for the cooperation in the areas of research and development, capacity building, health services, pharmaceutical trade and manufacturing capabilities for drugs and diagnostics.
- 3 The program would focus on training and strengthening capacity of health professionals, researchers, regulators and industry staff, support research collaborations for developing preventive tools and improved diagnostics for diseases which are regional priorities in India and Africa.



HEALTH CARE

4 The need is to focus on indigenous development of safe, affordable and effective drugs, diagnostics and vaccines towards addressing specific common regional disease burden and nurturing an ecosystem that has a strong impact on transforming the health standards of the population.

5 India exports 80% of its AIDS treatment to Africa.

6 India's Medical Tourism with its expertise in healthcare and affordable medicine, benefits Africa.



CAPACITY BUILDING

- 1 Africa is the largest beneficiary of India's ITEC program, thus helping in capacity building of African youth.
- 2 India extended \$5 billion line of credit for development initiatives including \$700 million for education and skill development in Africa.
- 3 India is investing more than \$1 billion in capacity building and training African youth in traditional and non-traditional security fields under the Indian Technical and Economic Cooperation (ITEC) program.
- 4 As a full member of African Capacity Building Foundation (ACBF), India has pledged \$1 million towards ACBF's sustainable development, poverty alleviation, and capacity building initiative.



CAPACITY BUILDING

5 India has invested \$100 million in the Pan-African E-Network to bridge the digital divide in Africa, links 53 countries through tele-medicine, tele-education and tele-governance, and plays a crucial role in fostering skills and human resources that are critical for Africa to develop in a sustainable way.

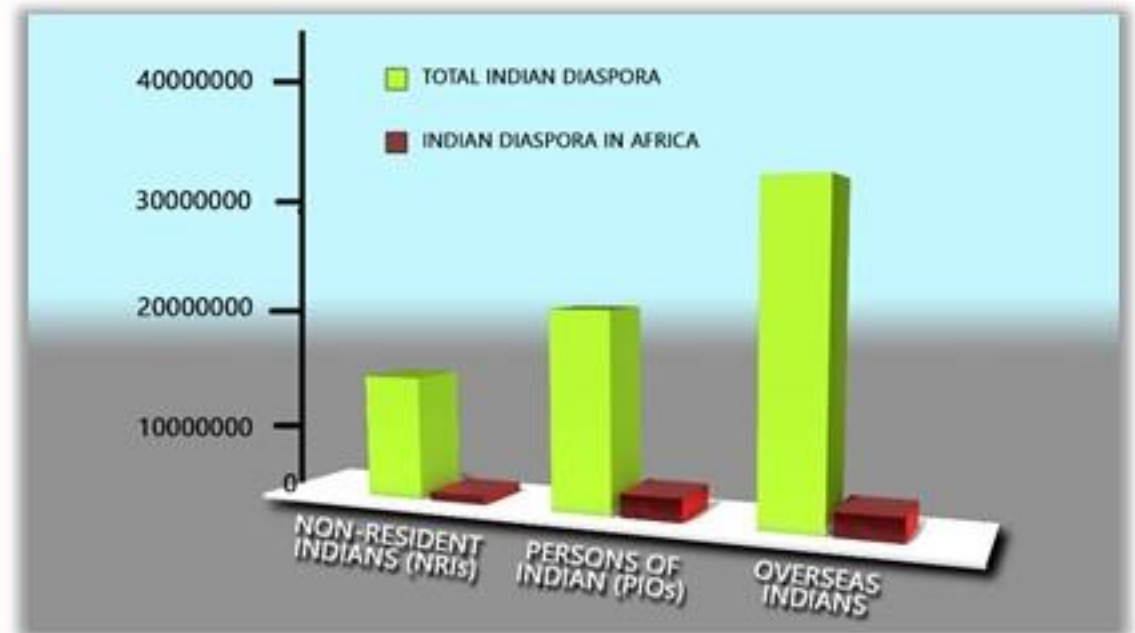
6 India has trained over 375 illiterate and semi-literate rural African women as Solar engineers or 'Solar Mamas'.

7 They are now able to fabricate, install and maintain household solar electrification system.



DIASPORA

- 1 Indian Diaspora is better integrated into the African community; as compared to the Chinese community.
- 2 India, at the same time, offers a much more familiar and open society and discourages racism.
- 3 Durban has the largest number of Indian Diaspora.
- 4 African continent provides a platform to India to reinforce its soft power through over two million strong Indian diaspora there.



ASIA-AFRICA GROWTH CORRIDOR

- 1 Asia-Africa Growth Corridor highlights the growing importance of Africa in India's foreign policy.
- 2 India engages with the African countries at three levels- bilateral, regional and multilateral.
- 3 In November 2016, Japan's PM Abe and Indian PM Modi resolved to “develop industrial corridors and industrial network for the growth of Asia and Africa.”



ASIA-AFRICA GROWTH CORRIDOR

4 In this regard, Indian and Japanese think tanks. unveiled the Vision Document of the Asian Africa Growth Corridor

5 It is based on the understanding that the global economic activities are shifting towards the Indo-Pacific region and India and Japan's commitment to evolve a strong economic, political and security architecture of the Indo-Pacific region.



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suggestions@learningspace.in

To Contact us:

info@learningspace.in

For Information:

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